MC 451 Codebook and Qualitative Memo rubric

50 points. Due Friday, October 23, 11:59 PM.

How this is scored. Add the points from each row; the total is out of 50. A first attempt is graded forgivingly: a part that is there but incomplete earns partial credit, and 0 is kept for a part that is missing. Writing more than the word range asks for never costs points. Submissions are unlimited before the deadline, so you can revise and submit again.

- The codebook rows total 35 and the memo 15. The two parts are graded together as one 50-point assignment.
- Safeguards to choose from: writing every category's inclusion and exclusion rule before coding begins; two or three prototypical examples per category drawn from your material; freezing the codebook before the full pass and logging every later change with its date and reason; keeping an ambiguous-case memo and settling each case against the written rule instead of by feel; coding in a fixed order with source details hidden wherever that is possible.

Codebook and Qualitative Memo, 50 points

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Codebook: study overview 3 points	**3 points.** Three to four sentences naming the question, the material you are coding, and the time period.	**2 points.** Names two of the three.	**1 point.** Present, but a reader still could not say what is being coded or from when.	**0 points.** Missing.
Codebook: unit of analysis 8 points	**8 points.** States exactly what one coded item is (one message, one post, one minute of video), once, and every variable is coded on that item.	**6 to 7 points.** Stated, but a variable is coded on something else (for example, the unit is one message but a variable describes the whole stream).	**4 to 5 points.** Stated loosely ("the comments", "the content"), so a reader could not tell where one item ends and the next begins.	**0 to 3 points.** Not stated.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Codebook: every variable 5 points	**5 points.** Every variable carries all five elements: conceptual definition, operational definition, level of measurement, coded values, and edge-case rules.	**4 points.** Every variable is here, but one or two are missing an element.	**3 points.** Several variables are missing elements, or a variable is listed by name only.	**0 to 2 points.** Variables are named without definitions.
Codebook: decision rules 7 points	**7 points.** Rules for the cases that do not sort themselves, each written as a rule ("If a message both praises and insults, code the first clause"), covering the hard calls you actually met.	**5 to 6 points.** Rules are there, but at least one is an intention instead of a rule, or a hard case you mention has no rule.	**4 points.** One or two rules for the whole codebook.	**0 to 3 points.** None.
Codebook: examples 5 points	**5 points.** Two or three examples per category, taken from your own material, each one clearly belonging to its category.	**4 points.** Examples for every category, but some are invented or there is only one per category.	**3 points.** Examples for some categories only. Without examples a rule is hard to use for anyone who was not in your head when you wrote it.	**0 to 2 points.** No examples.

Criterion	Exemplary	Proficient	Developing	Beginning
Codebook: single-coder note 7 points	**7 points.** Three short paragraphs: you say in plain words that you are the only coder and every reliability claim is about your own consistency; you name at least three safeguards you are using; and you give the second-coder counterfactual (how many items you would double-code, what number you would report, how you would train and settle disagreements, which finding is most at risk).	**5 to 6 points.** All three parts are there, but one is thin: fewer than three safeguards, or the counterfactual skips which finding is at risk.	**4 points.** Names the limitation but not the safeguards or the counterfactual, or describes a second coder as if one were part of the study.	**0 to 3 points.** Missing, or says nothing about being the only coder.
Qualitative memo 15 points	**15 points.** 200 to 300 words on the patterns you saw while immersed in your material, and each codebook category traces back to something the memo describes seeing.	**11 to 14 points.** Describes real patterns, but one or two categories cannot be traced back to anything in the memo.	**8 to 10 points.** Describes the topic in general instead of what you saw, or runs under 200 words, which usually means the link from what you saw to each category is missing: name the pattern behind each category.	**0 to 7 points.** A summary of the topic or the plan, with no patterns from your own watching or reading.

Before you submit

Codebook Check reads a pasted codebook and reports what this assignment asks for that your draft does not have yet: a unit of analysis stated once, both definitions on every variable, a declared level of measurement, a catch-all category, a description on every category, category pairs that may overlap, decision rules, and examples. It does not grade, and nothing you enter leaves your machine.